You're Invited to Join The SPARK Team. The **S**ignature **P**rogram **A**dvancement, **R**esearch and **K**nowledge (SPARK) team is comprised of educators, leaders, district staff, families and community members. Members possess unique knowledge, experience, and subject matter expertise as it relates to SUSD's signature school and program choices.

Role and Purpose

The Scottsdale's SPARK Team role is to serve as the district's collaborative body for program development, review, monitoring, and continuous improvement of signature programs and specialty schools.

The team's purpose is to: (1) Evaluate signature program proposals, (2) Recommend new program locations, (3) Review program performance and status, (4) Research unique and new school programming models, (5) Provide implementation and strategic planning supports to schools/programs, (6) Recommend the continuation or removal of program status.

Time Commitment

- Large team meets Quarterly for 3 hours to develop, monitor and adjust strategies related to specialty program implementation
- Subgroups may meet more frequently (monthly, bi-weekly) when reviewing new program proposals

Team Membership:

- School principals, teachers, program coordinators and parents from current signature programs and schools.
- District leaders and staff members who work directly with signature programs/schools
- Community Members- each learning community will have two designated members (one elementary, one secondary)
- Parents- each learning community will have two parent representatives (one elementary, one secondary)
- Subject Matter Experts- when new programs are being explored/developed, the SPARK team will recruit staff, community or other members with specific subject matter expertise to participate in the design and proposal process.

Current Program Themes	Potential Program Themes
❖ STEAM & MSA- Navajo, Laguna, Saguaro, Mohave ❖ Traditional School Program Model- Cheyenne ❖ Dual Language Immersion- Pueblo, Mohave, DCES, DCMS ❖ International Baccalaureate (IB)- Anasazi, Mountainside, Desert Mountain ❖ Comprehensive Gifted Programs (CGP) ❖ Advancement Via Individual Determination (AVID)- Arcadia, Ingleside, Tavan, Hohokam ❖ College and Career Academies- All high schools	• Arts Magnet • Gifted and Advanced Academics • Early College Small School Model

Expected Outcomes from SPARK Team

1. Program Development Recommendations
    a. Annual or semi-annual recommendations for new specialty programs, program expansions, or program redesigns.
    b. Identification of high-demand themes based on community, workforce, and educational trends.
2. Program Performance Review
    a. Completion of annual review reports for each specialty program, including strengths, challenges, and growth opportunities.
    b. Recommendations for improvement plans for programs not meeting performance expectations.
3. Program Quality Standards
    a. Development and refinement of consistent quality indicators for specialty programs (instructional, operational, engagement, equity).
4. Community & Stakeholder Engagement
    a. Summary of community input gathered through forums, surveys, and outreach activities.
    b. Recommendations based on stakeholder feedback to guide future specialty program decisions.
5. Facilities & Resource Planning Input
    a. Identification of facility considerations aligned with specialty program needs.
    b. Recommendations related to technology, equipment, staffing, and professional development.
6. Communication & Awareness Support
    a. Guidance on communication strategies and messaging for specialty program promotion.
    b. Identification of target audiences and recommended outreach approaches.
7. Annual SPARK Team Report
    a. An annual summary delivered to district leadership outlining SPARK Team activities, program evaluations, and recommendations for the upcoming year.